

Gautam Velpula

VP / Head of Enterprise Architecture & Platform Engineering

Digital Platforms • Payments • Martech • Cloud & Data Modernization

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Executive Summary

Technology leader with deep experience driving enterprise-scale digital transformation across multi-brand retail, payments, marketing technology, and data platforms. Proven ability to modernize legacy systems, unify fragmented architectures, and deliver resilient, revenue-critical platforms. Combines executive strategy, hands-on technical leadership, and team building to accelerate time-to-market, improve reliability, and align technology investments with business outcomes.

Professional Experience

GoTo Foods LLC

2021 – Present

Sr Director, Enterprise Architecture

- Led enterprise architecture and platform strategy for a multi-brand restaurant organization, serving as the single architectural authority across digital, marketing, payments, and data.
- Defined and executed a unified digital platform consolidating 7 independent brand apps and websites, materially reducing development and maintenance costs.
- Re-architected backend systems to a microservices and event-driven model, standardizing APIs, service contracts, and integration patterns.
- Designed and led payments integration with FreedomPay, enabling digital wallets and modern check-out experiences across brands.
- Architected and delivered a subscription service to support evolving business models, including hands-on development of a stop-gap service to stabilize revenue during legacy system failures.
- Designed and governed Martech and CDP integrations, aligning third-party platforms with a centralized customer data model to enable accurate analytics, attribution, and personalization.
- Standardized analytics and event instrumentation across web, mobile, and backend systems, improving data quality and cross-brand reporting.
- Lead the **GoTo Foods AI Working Group**, the enterprise governing body that reviews and approves all AI-based initiatives company-wide, ensuring strategic alignment, technical viability, and adherence to security, compliance, and AI governance standards.
- Leading the design and implementation of **agentic AI use cases** across digital platforms and internal systems, focused on automation, decision support, and operational efficiency.
- Driving enterprise adoption of **LLM-enabled development practices**, defining architectural patterns, guardrails, and best practices for safe and scalable usage.
- Partnering with engineering, data, and product teams to embed LLM capabilities into APIs, event-driven services, and internal tooling.
- Partnered with security and compliance to establish governance and operational standards for AI-assisted development, balancing speed, cost, security, and reliability.
- Reduced time-to-market by approximately 40% and improved system uptime by approximately 30%.
- Built and led a senior architecture organization, managing principal and lead architects while fostering a culture of continuous improvement.
- Remained hands-on during periods of attrition and transformation, taking on delivery responsibilities when needed.

Slalom Consulting Senior Delivery Principal

2018 – 2021

- Served as senior delivery and advisory lead for complex, multi-million-dollar digital transformation, cloud modernization, and payments initiatives for Fortune 500 and large-scale eCommerce clients.
- Led cross-functional teams spanning engineering, architecture, product, and design across multi-year engagements.
- Acted as primary executive-facing delivery and technology advisor, translating business strategy into actionable roadmaps.
- Conducted a multi-year enterprise assessment of a legacy payments platform for one of the largest eCommerce companies in the U.S., defining the target-state architecture and modernization roadmap.
- Led a major cloud migration from on-premises and AWS to GCP for a leading point-of-sale provider.
- Designed and delivered payment processing systems for a large financial services organization.
- Directed multiple multi-million-dollar engagements, achieving approximately 95% client satisfaction and repeat business.
- Implemented Agile and DevOps operating models, increasing deployment frequency by approximately 30% and reducing lead time by approximately 25%.
- Partnered with sales and pre-sales teams to scope, estimate, and win high-value engagements.
- Mentored delivery leaders and principals, strengthening leadership depth and delivery maturity.

Jacada (acquired by Uniphore) Director, Professional Services

2014 – 2018

- Owned global professional services delivery for enterprise customers, leading large-scale implementations for Fortune 500 clients.
- Held end-to-end accountability for delivery from pre-sales through post-implementation optimization.
- Led multi-year enterprise programs, delivering complex integrations and customizations.
- Acted as a trusted advisor to C-level stakeholders, aligning delivery with business objectives and driving organizational change.
- Served as the senior-most technical leader within services, providing architectural guidance and escalation support.
- Supported sales through POCs, demos, and solution design, directly influencing deal closure.
- Partnered with product management to influence product roadmap based on client needs and delivery insights.
- Built and scaled a world-class professional services organization through recruiting, training, and standardized delivery practices.
- Remained hands-on as needed to address critical technical challenges.

Technology Stack

Languages & Frameworks: TypeScript, Node.js, Java (Spring Boot), NestJS, Next.js, React Native, Tailwind CSS

Cloud & Platform: Microsoft Azure (AKS, Front Door, API Management, Functions, Blob Storage), Google Cloud Platform (GCP), Vercel, Cloudflare

Data & Messaging: Cosmos DB (MongoDB & PostgreSQL APIs), Databricks, Event Hub, Service Bus

Analytics & Observability: GA4, Firebase, Splunk

Payments, Martech & Integrations: FreedomPay, Amperity CDP, Olo, Punchh, Yext, Qu POS

Core Strengths

Enterprise & Platform Architecture • Payments & Subscriptions • Martech & CDP Integration • Cloud Modernization • Executive Stakeholder Management • Organization Building • Legacy Modernization

& Risk Mitigation

Education

Master of Science in Information Technology

2007 – 2009

George Mason University, Fairfax, VA

Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science

2002 – 2006

Osmania University, Hyderabad, India